

01

Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Broad IKS revival is context only, not evidence for doctrine.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Navya-Nyāya refinements, the pramāṇa–pramāṇaphala debate and detailed rival objections are CORE SUPPORTING DEPTH when tied to the question.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Broad IKS revival is context only, not evidence for doctrine.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Broad IKS revival is context only, not evidence for doctrine.

ANSWER LINE: The seven categories, four pramāṇas, perception and inference, anyathākhyāti, self, apavarga, Īśvara, Udayana's proofs, asatkāryavāda and atomism are CORE SYLLABUS.

02

Contemporary-anchor discipline

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Search finding: A live August 2026 search located broad educational and academic discussion of Indian Knowledge Systems and classical Indian logic, but no sufficiently direct official doctrinal development specific to Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ Inference: Mention renewed interest in Indian logical traditions only as a bounded introduction or conclusion.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Do not turn curriculum discussion into proof of a metaphysical or epistemological claim.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

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03

Master distinction gateway

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Master verdict: Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika is a realist system in which a detailed ontology is disclosed through valid cognition, error is a misrelation among real factors, and liberation follows removal of false knowledge.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Memory line: seven categories prevent unlike kinds of reality from being confused.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

□ Its concern is not logic in an abstract formalist sense alone, but valid cognition as a means to the removal of error and finally liberation.

ANSWER LINE: Master verdict: Nyāya–Vaiśeṣika is a realist system in which a detailed ontology is disclosed through valid cognition, error is a misrelation among real factors, and liberation follows removal of false knowledge.